

Congressman Keith Rothfus (ret.)

**227 Walnut Street
Sewickley, PA 15143**

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Submitted electronically to [REDACTED]

Networking and Information Technology Research and Development
National Coordination Office/National Science Foundation
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

RE: RFI on Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan
FR Doc: 2025-02305

To Whom It May Concern:

On January 23, 2025, President Donald Trump issued Executive Order 14179 calling for the development of an artificial intelligence (AI) action plan that would achieve the policy of the United States of sustaining our nation's global AI dominance "in order to promote human flourishing, economic competitiveness, and national security." Subsequently, the White House issued a request for information (RFI) inviting interested parties for ideas on actions that should be included in the AI action plan.

The RFI's call for input directly from the American people on AI policy ideas demonstrates the Trump administration's understanding of how revolutionary business, economic and technological developments may impact the quality of life of everyday Americans. That President Trump would solicit such feedback is reflective of, and consistent with, his near stand-alone critique of another economic trend that took place in the second half of the twentieth century. In that case, Wall Street, Washington power brokers and ivory tower academics pushed policy prescriptions that resulted in unfair trade actions (including the admission of China to the WTO) that closed factories across western Pennsylvania, upstate New York, New England, Ohio, Michigan, Indiana, Illinois and Wisconsin and did great harm to "human flourishing" in these areas. The country simply cannot afford another policy mistake, particularly in such a far-reaching endeavor as AI.

The analytical power of AI provides great promise to help humanity meet the pressing problems we face. Finding cures to disease, tackling environmental challenges, improving education, making government more efficient, eliminating waste, fraud and abuse in both the public and private sector, facilitating better transportation systems, and bringing to justice those involved in narcotics and human trafficking and related money-laundering are just some of the results we can expect in the coming decades as AI-leveraged applications are deployed. On the other hand, AI will present challenges with regard to the need for workers to adapt to different occupations, the collection of data from those who use AI applications and the related issue of privacy of such users, the responsibility of those who put AI applications into the marketplace,

the potential – especially for the young – for psychological or neurological harm or degradation of critical thinking for users of AI applications, the replacement of humans with robots as caregivers, protecting the intellectual property rights of authors whose works may be used in training AI models, military or law enforcement AI applications that may take a “human outside the loop” when confronted with life and death situations, the ability of AI to convey or promote philosophical or ethical principles, and lastly, the understanding of what it means to be human and attempts to convey on machines anything comparable to the rights of persons.

As the Trump administration considers an AI policy framework and action plan to address the evolving AI landscape, if it wants AI to result in true human flourishing, it would be well advised to consider how to avoid the aforementioned pitfalls that have the potential to produce a devastation even greater than what is found in old rust belt towns. To that end, the administration should consider including in its AI action plan the proposal of regulatory or legislative policies, as appropriate, in accordance with following:

- Means to facilitate job training programs designed to assist workers in adapting to new occupations in the event AI makes their old jobs obsolete.
- Means of holding accountable providers of AI systems that cause psychological or neurological harm to users of such AI systems.
- Means for users of AI systems to be protected from having data acquired through their use of such AI systems from being used by the provider of the system unless the user has opted in to such use, with such opt-in not being obscured in a lengthy terms and conditions of use.
- Means to protect minors from engaging such AI systems without parental involvement.
- Means to protect the intellectual property of authors whose works may be used in training or teaching AI systems.
- The prohibition of employees and agents of the Federal government from using, and the prohibition of Federal grants and contracts to private sector parties that provide or use, AI systems or supportive infrastructure that are:
 - embedded with ideological bias or social engineering agendas (such as, for example, AI systems that reject basic objective truths such as the reality of two genders, the rejection of the sanctity of all human life from fertilization until natural death, the truth that every human has a mother and a father, etc.);
 - facilitate or enable the distribution of pornography;
 - embryo selection or germ line gene editing through CRISPR or any similar technology

Regarding bias in AI systems, while EO 14179 calls for the development of “AI systems that are free from ideological bias or engineered social agendas,” given the subjectivity and relativity that governs academic and public discourse today, an AI action plan that calls for a mandate for AI systems to seek truth (not just “my truth” or “your truth,” but the truth) and what is good should not be deemed to be an ideological pursuit. It is ideologies and social engineering, as so clearly seen in the transgenderism movement, that seek to take us away from truth. And to be clear, truth is not the same as what more than 50% of a community may believe; if a majority of people, for example, living in the ante-bellum south believed slavery was consistent with the Declaration of Independence’s recognition of inalienable rights to life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness for all men, that did not make the proposition true.

- The prohibition of any agency of the Federal government from recognizing any rights in an AI-generated bot, agent or similar application or mechanism that is akin to the rights of human beings. For example, an AI bot should never be recognized as person with the rights recognized in our Declaration of Independence and Constitution, regardless of the subjective belief that any person may have with respect to such a bot. The idea that one may have a legally recognized familial, marital or other personal “relationship” with an AI bot or agent must also be rejected. Here, the Federal government must operate from a perspective that embraces the concept of embodiment as being necessary for the recognition of rights of the person, that is that humans consist of mind, body and soul.
- Federal policy should declare that AI systems in the defense and law enforcement sectors will not use deadly force without there being a “human in the loop.”

The Trump administration is to be commended in the approach to AI that is evidenced in EO 14179 and the RFI. I would encourage the administration to consider the points made in this submittal along with others who are expressing similar concerns. This document is approved for public dissemination. The document contains no business-proprietary or confidential information. Document contents may be reused by the government in developing the AI Action Plan and associated documents without attribution.

Respectfully submitted,

Keith Rothfus
Former member of the U.S. House of Representatives
(Pennsylvania’s Twelfth District, 2013-2019)